

New York Aims
To Clear Streets
Of Mentally Ill

Moving to Hospitalize
Some Involuntarily

By ANDY NEWMAN
and EMMA G. FITZSIMMONS

Acting to address “a crisis we see all around us” toward the end of a year that has seen a string of high-profile crimes involving homeless people, Mayor Eric Adams announced a major push on Tuesday to remove people with severe, untreated mental illness from the city’s streets and subways.

Mr. Adams, who has made clearing homeless encampments a priority since taking office in January, said the effort would require involuntarily hospitalizing people who were a danger to themselves, even if they posed no risk of harm to others, arguing the city had a “moral obligation” to help them.

“The common misunderstanding persists that we cannot provide involuntary assistance unless the person is violent,” Mr. Adams said in an address at City Hall. “Going forward, we will make every effort to assist those who are suffering from mental illness.”

The mayor’s announcement comes at a heated moment in the national debate about rising crime and the role of the police, especially in dealing with people who are already in fragile mental health. Republicans, as well as tough-on-crime Democrats like Mr. Adams, a former police captain, have argued that growing disorder calls for more aggressive measures. Left-leaning advocates and officials who dominate New York politics say that deploying the police as auxiliary social workers may do more harm than good.

Other large cities have struggled with how to help homeless people, in particular those dealing with mental illness. In California, Gov. Gavin Newsom recently signed a law that could force some homeless people with disorders like schizophrenia into treatment. Many states have laws that allow for involuntary outpatient treatment, and Washington State allows people to be committed to hospitals if a judge finds that they pose a threat to themselves or others.

Officials in New York said the city would roll out training immediately to police officers, Emergency Medical Services staff and other medical personnel to “ensure compassionate care.” But the city’s new directive on the policy acknowledges that “case law does not provide extensive guidance regarding removals for mental health evaluations based on short interactions in the field.”

The policy immediately raised

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FINBARR O'REILLY FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Exhuming six bodies from a common grave in Pravdyne, Ukraine, on Monday. There was evidence that the six had been executed.

Jolted Awake,
Beijing Hurries
To Quell Unrest

By CHRIS BUCKLEY

Reacting to China’s boldest and most widespread protests in decades, the security apparatus built by Communist Party leader Xi Jinping is mobilizing on multiple fronts to quash dissent, drawing on its decades-old tool kit of repression and surveillance.

In a meeting of the party’s top security leaders, reported in state media on Tuesday, officials were ordered to “resolutely crack down on illegal and criminal acts that disrupt social order.” And by evening, the demonstrations already appeared to be smaller and more scattered, with new videos emerging on social media showing only groups of residents in several different locked-down developments demanding to be freed.

At the same time, the government announced that it would step up vaccinations of older adults. That move is deemed crucial to easing China’s tight Covid controls that have fueled public anger, signaling that as Beijing suppresses dissent, it is also moving to address the problem underlying the protests.

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In Russians’ Wake, Joy Quickly Turns to Horror

By JEFFREY GETTLEMAN

PRAVDYNE, Ukraine — First came small pieces of bone. Then a pair of arms tied at the wrists with rope.

And then the shovel unearthed a skull with a bullet hole, mouth cracked open, teeth covered in thick, black mud.

Even though scenes like this have been repeated across Ukraine wherever the Russians have retreated, the clump of villagers and police officers seemed stunned on Monday as they stood at the lip of a common grave in Pravdyne, a village near the city of Kherson.

A cold rain pelted their backs, but they didn’t move as the grave was exhumed. None of the villagers even knew the last names

In South as Elsewhere
in Ukraine, Signs of
Atrocities Emerge

of the six men who had been killed, execution-style, and then buried here, but that didn’t matter.

“They were Ukrainians,” said Kostiantyn Podoliak, a prosecutor who had come to investigate.

And now their remains lay in a shallow grave because of it.

Kherson and the surrounding villages in southern Ukraine were liberated, after eight brutal months of occupation, when embattled Russian forces abruptly pulled out more than two weeks ago. Residents streamed into the

streets, waving flags, hugging soldiers and clinking glasses of cognac.

But as the days have passed, that elation has given way to mounting evidence of atrocities, and the sobering reality of battered, barely livable communities from which most civilians fled months ago and may not return to anytime soon. The Russians, on their way out, blew up power stations, taking down electricity, running water, heat and phone service, and casting residents back more than a century.

And though the Russians are gone, they continue to kill people in and around Kherson, a city that was home to some 280,000 people before the war. Nearly every morning, the whomp of Russian

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CLAUDIO VILLA/GETTY IMAGES

One Is Enough for the U.S.

Christian Pulisic scored in a 1-0 victory over Iran as the U.S. advanced at the World Cup. Page B6.

Motivated by Federal Aid, Utilities Are Embracing Clean Energy

By ERIC LIPTON

WASHINGTON — Just two years ago, DTE Energy, a Michigan-based electric utility, was still enmeshed in a court fight with federal regulators over emissions from a coal-burning power plant on the western shore of Lake Erie that ranks as one of the nation’s

largest sources of climate-changing air pollution.

But in September, Gerard M. Anderson, who led DTE for the last decade, was on the South Lawn of the White House alongside hundreds of other supporters of President Biden, giving a standing ovation to the president for his success in pushing a climate change package through Con-

Wind and Solar Power
Now More Attractive

gress — a law that will help accelerate the closure of the very same coal-burning behemoth, known as DTE Monroe, that his company had been fighting to protect.

LATE EDITION
Today, cloudy, periodic rain, very windy, high 57. **Tonight**, cloudy, rain early, still windy, low 34. **Tomorrow**, partly cloudy, colder, blustery, high 44. Weather map is on Page B16.

TOP LAWMAKERS
RUSH TO PREVENT
A RAIL SHUTDOWN

HEEDING CALL BY BIDEN

Bipartisan Effort Stoked
by Economic Concern
Before Holidays

By MICHAEL D. SHEAR
and EMILY COCHRANE

WASHINGTON — Democratic and Republican leaders in Congress vowed on Tuesday to pass legislation averting a nationwide rail strike, saying they agreed with President Biden that a work stoppage during the holidays next month would disrupt shipping and deal a devastating blow to the nation’s economy.

The rare bipartisan promise to act came as some of the nation’s largest business groups warned of dire consequences from a rail shutdown. Mr. Biden, who had promised to be the most pro-union president in the country’s history, said the federal government must short-circuit collective bargaining in this case for the good of the country as a whole.

“It’s not an easy call, but I think we have to do it,” he told the top four lawmakers from both parties during a meeting at the White House on Tuesday morning, as the



DOUG MILLS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

President Biden met with congressional leaders on Tuesday.

Dec. 9 strike deadline loomed. “The economy is at risk.”

Speaker Nancy Pelosi said the House would vote on Wednesday on a tentative agreement that Mr. Biden’s administration had helped negotiate between rail companies and the unions earlier this year. The agreement raised wages but lacked provisions for paid medical or family leave.

Late on Tuesday, facing substantial frustration among progressives who demanded that the offer include paid leave, Ms. Pelosi said she would also bring up a separate proposal to add seven days of paid sick leave to the agreement. It is unclear whether Republicans in the Senate would agree to such an addition, but the plan to hold a vote illustrated the degree of discontent among pro-union liberals about the agreement Mr. Biden struck.

“They demand the basic dignity of paid sick days. I stand with them,” Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez, Democrat of New York, said on Twitter. “If Congress intervenes, it should be to have workers’ backs and secure their demands in legislation.”

Senate leaders said they would work to pass legislation to avert the strike quickly after it passes the House, as expected. Senator

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Oath Keepers Leader Convicted
Of Sedition in a Key Jan. 6 Case

By ALAN FEUER and ZACH MONTAGUE

Stewart Rhodes, the leader of the far-right Oath Keepers militia, was convicted on Tuesday along with one of his subordinates of seditious conspiracy as a jury found them guilty of seeking to keep former President Donald J. Trump in power through an extensive plot that started after the 2020 election and culminated in the mob attack on the Capitol.

The jury in Federal District Court in Washington found three other defendants in the case not guilty of sedition and acquitted Mr. Rhodes of two separate conspiracy charges.

The split verdicts, coming after three days of deliberations, were a landmark — if not total — victory for the Justice Department, which poured enormous effort into prosecuting Mr. Rhodes and his four co-defendants.

The sedition convictions marked the first time in nearly 20 trials related to the Capitol attack that a jury had decided that the violence that erupted on Jan. 6, 2021, was the product of an organized conspiracy.

Seditious conspiracy is the most serious charge brought so far in any of the 900 criminal cases stemming from the vast investigation of the Capitol attack, an inquiry that could still result in scores, if not hundreds, of additional arrests. Mr. Rhodes, 57, was also found guilty of obstructing the certification of the election during a joint session of Congress on Jan. 6 and of destroying evidence in

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Beijing’s Milestone in Space

A rocket launched in the Gobi Desert transported three astronauts to China’s newly completed space station. Page A9

Macron Prepares to Visit U.S.

In talks with President Biden, France’s leader will discuss how to share the burdens of the war in Ukraine. Page A4

NATIONAL A10-17, 20

Senate Passes Marriage Bill

A 61-to-36 vote sent the measure on same-sex and interracial marriage back to the House, which is expected to pass it and send it to the president. Page A11

New Data on Alzheimer’s Drug

A clinical trial found that the experimental drug, lecanemab, helped some patients but also carried risks of brain swelling and bleeding. Page A10

Embattled Restaurant Closes

The widely known Willows Inn, on a tiny island in the Pacific Northwest, had faced harassment and bias claims, as well as costly litigation. Page A16



ARTS C1-8

More Diversity in Indianapolis

As a museum grows more inclusive, a nonprofit is helping the city improve its relationship with Black artists. Page C1

Extending Life of ‘Phantom’

After a spike in ticket sales for “Phantom of the Opera,” a planned closing of the show will be delayed. Page C1

BUSINESS B1-5

Chaotic Final Days of FTX

Emails and texts show how lawyers and executives struggled to persuade the founder of FTX to cede control of his collapsing crypto exchange. Page B1

SPORTS B6-13

Steroid Era Fallout in Baseball

A Hall of Fame committee is looking skeptically at players accused of using performance enhancers, like Barry Bonds and Roger Clemens. Page B13

OPINION A18-19

Tressie McMillan Cottom

Page A19



FOOD D1-10

A Taste for the West Coast

In her new cookbook, Tanya Holland offers many recipes that celebrate the Black farmers, cooks and artisans who changed California’s cuisine. Page D9

